

Potty Training in Three Days - Printable Checklists and Trackers

From *Potty Training in Three Days* by Beth Ashcroft (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

The Readiness Checklist

Work through this **before you buy anything**. There is no official pass mark. As a practical rule: most of the bladder signs plus most of the physical ones, with some interest, is a good position to start from.

Bladder

	Yes
Stays dry for two hours or more, or wakes dry from a nap	
There is a recognisable pattern to when she goes	
She has a tell - goes still, hides, crosses legs, pulls at the nappy	
She tells you afterwards	
She tells you during	
She tells you beforehand	

Physical

	Yes
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Walks to the potty, sits down and gets up unaided	
Pulls trousers down and up, roughly	
Bowel movements are fairly predictable	
Poos are soft and comfortable - no pain, no straining, no holding on	

Developmental

	Yes
Follows a simple two-step instruction	
Can communicate a need somehow	
Shows interest - follows you in, wants to watch, asks	
Dislikes being wet or dirty, or asks to be changed	

The stop sign

Any sign of holding on to poo, pain passing it, or hard stools - do not start. Deal with that first. It is the commonest hidden reason training fails.

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Not readiness signs

Being two. A new baby. Nursery policy. What your mother remembers. Your own exhaustion with nappies.

The Three Days at a Glance

	What you do	What normal looks like
Day before	Clear the diary. Wash everything. Potties out, rugs up, nappies out of sight. Tell her once. Let her choose pants.	A slightly excited child and a nervous parent
Day one	Bare from the waist down. Drink every 20-30 min. Prompt every 20 min as an instruction, not a question. Sit 2-3 min max. Watch for the tell.	6-12 accidents, 1-2 catches, everyone tired
Day two	Prompts to every 30 min. Add pants, no trousers. Go in the garden. Let her empty and flush.	Often worse than day one. This is the dip. Carry on.
Day three	Add trousers. One short trip out, no pull-up. Start thinning the prompts.	2-4 accidents, some telling you first
Day four	Catching some? Carry on. Nothing at all, or distress, or withholding? Stop kindly, retry in 4-8 weeks	Either outcome is normal

The three rules

- 1. No pull-ups in the daytime.** Going back and forth is what stretches three days into three months.
- 2. Never punish an accident** - not with a word, a sigh, or a face.

3. Sitting is two to three minutes. Never hold a child on a potty.

The Accident and Pattern Tracker

Keep this for the three days, and for a fortnight afterwards if things are not settling. It turns a vague bad day into a visible pattern, and it is what a doctor will want if you end up at an appointment.

Time	Wee / poo	In potty or accident	Did she tell you?	What she was doing	Drink in last hour?

Reading it back

- Are catches increasing at all across the days? Even slightly is working.
- Has she told you beforehand even once? That is the skill arriving.
- Do accidents cluster during absorbing play? Normal - use a timed prompt.
- **Has there been a poo at all since you started?** If not, read the withholding chapter today.

The Day-Four Decision Sheet

Three days are up and you are not sure. Tick down both columns.

Carry on if	Stop if
She is catching some, even occasionally	Three days with essentially no catches
She has told you beforehand at least once	No sign she recognises the sensation
Accidents are reducing, even slightly	Distress about the potty getting worse
She sits without much fuss	Complete refusal to sit at all
	Holding on for long stretches, then flooding
	Any sign of holding on to poo
	Constantly wet with no pattern

If you are stopping

Nappies back on. Say it lightly: *"I think we'll have a rest from the potty for a bit. We'll try again when you're ready."*

Do not say she has failed, that you are disappointed, or that big girls do this. Leave the potty out. Say nothing about it.

Try again in four to eight weeks, and re-check the readiness list first - especially the two-hours-dry sign.

Before you try again, rule out: constipation or withholding, and a urinary infection.

Note for Nursery, Childminder or Grandparents

Please fill this in and hand it over. Specific instructions are much easier to follow than a general request to be supportive.

Child's name	
We say this for wee	
We say this for poo	
Started training on	

How we do it

Please prompt roughly every	minutes
Prompts work better as an instruction than a question - "let's go and sit on the potty" rather than "do you need a wee?"	
Please do not use pull-ups in the daytime	
If there is an accident, please just change her without remarking on it - no "oh dear", no disappointment	
She needs help with wiping	yes / no
She needs help with clothes	yes / no
She needs a step or a seat insert	yes / no

Things that frighten her

(hand dryers, automatic flushes, a particular toilet)

Anything else

When to See a Doctor

Take the tracker with you. A fortnight of specifics is far more useful than a general account.

	Applies
Any sign of withholding - tiptoes, stiff legs, crossing, hiding, clenching while trying not to go	
Poos are hard, painful, very large, or there is blood	
Soiling or skid marks in a child who is otherwise trained	
Pain or crying on weeing, very frequent weeing, smelly or cloudy urine, fever	
Sudden wetting in a child who had been reliably dry	
Three failed training attempts	
No interest at all by about three and a half to four	

Any soiling in a child over four	
Daytime wetting in a child over five	
Bedwetting still happening at five to seven, or restarting after six months dry	
Dribbling constantly, or a weak or odd stream	
Distress that has become a feature of family life	

Four questions worth asking

Could this be constipation, even though she goes most days?
If we treat it, how long should treatment continue? (Usually months, not days.)
Should we stop training while we deal with this?
When should we come back if it has not improved?